

music players with an official support lifeline, then here are five of the best that may help you forget about how awesome Winamp was.

1. Media Monkey

The true Winamp alternative, Media Monkey does everything that Winamp can (and a little bit more). If you have a large music library and have compulsive tendencies when it comes to keeping it organised, Media Monkey will suit your needs. Media Monkey also supports a huge variety of audio formats including high fidelity ones like WAV, FLAC and OGG apart from common ones like MP3 and AAC. The player also supports plug-ins and skins, so if that was what you loved about Winamp, then you'll also learn to love Media Monkey.

Download: <http://www.mediamonkey.com/download/>

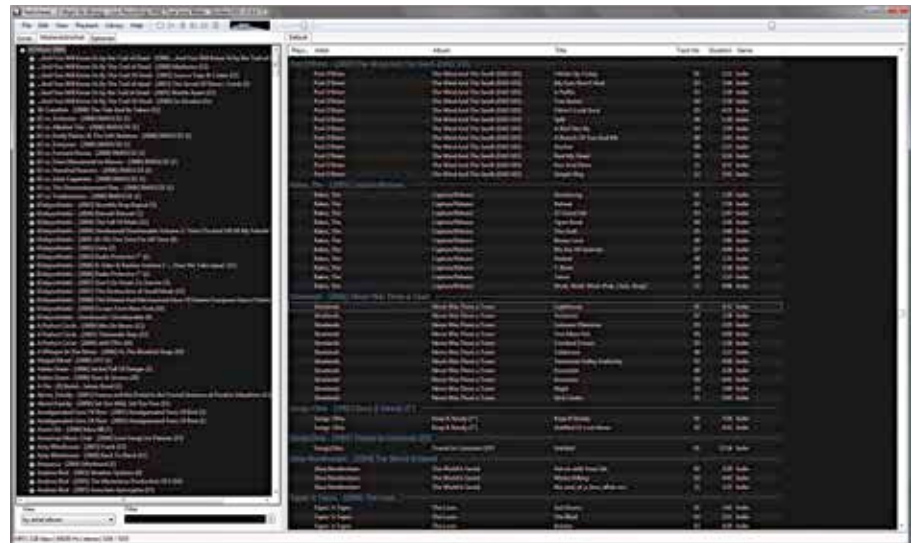
2. Foobar2000

If what attracted you to Winamp was its 'mini' avatar which you could use to quickly queue up and play individual tracks, then you should look at Foobar2000. Foobar is light on system resources, has a simple UI and is blazing fast even on underpowered machines. While Foobar is not the best option to manage large organised libraries, it can still do this provided you spend some time customising it. Foobar also supports all the popular audio formats including OGG and FLAC.

Download: <http://www.foobar2000.org/download>

3. AIMP3

AIMP3 is another music player reminiscent of Winamp's 'mini' version. It offers a single pane view in which you can queue up individual songs or playlists. However, if you want to manage your entire library, you can still do so by jumping to the album manager option. It won't provide as much information up front as Winamp, but it works. AIMP3 also offers a ton of customisation options to change the way it



Foobar2000 is blazingly fast even on slow machines

works and looks, and a whole bunch of equalizer options and presets.

Download: <http://www.aimp2.us/aimp3-download.php>

4. MusicBee

MusicBee is another very good alternative to consider if keeping a large music library organised is your priority. Like Winamp and Media Monkey, MusicBee also lets you view your entire music library at a glance through multiple panes for tracks, albums, artists etc. Auto-tagging and manual tagging are also built-in features along with support for custom playlists and online information on the artist you may be listening to.

Download: <http://www.getmusicbee.com/download/>

5. Windows Media Player

Yes, we know, we know. We'll wait till you finish laughing. Done? Good. There's a

reason why Windows Media Player still remains the most popular music player on Windows. And it's not just because it comes pre-installed on Windows (although that's a big reason). WMP is an easy-to-use player whether you want to use it to play single songs and playlists or manage your music library. WMP may not have the best format support (unless you install codecs manually) but it's a good looking software that's easy to pick up and use and suited for people who want to just listen to music and not mess around with the player itself.

The elephant in the room: iTunes

You may be wondering why we didn't include iTunes in the list of the five alternatives to Winamp even though it's undoubtedly one of the most popular media players on the planet. There's a simple reason for that: iTunes on Windows is unwieldier than a drunken one-legged elephant on a unicycle with a punctured tire. Everything takes an inordinate amount of time to do in iTunes, from starting it up to downloading online information to syncing music to your iPhone. In fact, despite owning an iPhone, most of us seldom kickstart iTunes and instead rely on Copy Trans Manager for almost everything music related.

However, if you do plan on buying lots of music from iTunes (iTunes definitely has some killer deals on music for Indian users) and use other services like iTunes Match and also own multiple Apple devices, then iTunes will suit you. **d**



Media Monkey helps you stay super-organised